

First Name: Pranavsai

Last Name: Gandikota

Incoming SWE Intern @ Ford | TA for OOP @ UCF CECS | Design @ KnightHacks | Backend Dev @ SASE | Director @ ISA | Prev. SIL for CS1 @ SARC | Prev AI URA @ ISUE Lab | CS @ UCF
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<https://www.linkedin.com/in/pranavsai>

Summary

Computer Science student at UCF interested in software developer positions as well as artificial intelligence, and machine learning.

Experience

Backend Web Developer at SASE

January 2026 -

Helping with organizing and creating student database on Supabase and creating components for functionality of the SASE website

Project Team Lead at Knight Hacks

January 2026 -

Led a 6-member team to develop a secure video networking platform for university students, managing the project lifecycle from initial concept to deployment for Project Launch 2026.

Built the backend with Spring Boot and utilized WebRTC to facilitate low-latency, real-time peer connections for campus networking.

Enforced student-only access by implementing mandatory .edu email verification and integrating Auth0 for secure authentication.

Developed a custom moderation tool featuring recursive video clipping and scheduled deletion to handle incident reporting while maintaining data privacy.

Managed full-stack infrastructure by containerizing services with Docker and deploying to GCP Cloud Run for scalable hosting.

Teacher Assistant at UCF College of Engineering & Computer Science

January 2026 -

Assisting Dr Arup Guha in the OOP w/ Java course as a TA. Grading papers, helping organize the course, holding office hours every week for 250 students, and invigilating exams for the professor.

Knights Shadow at BNY

December 2025 - December 2025

Networked with professionals and managers of BNY

Got insight into working of BNY

Talked to professionals in field regarding workflow of a financial service company especially in SWE roles

Campus Partner | Perplexity at Perplexity

September 2025 - December 2025

Promoting Perplexity AI on campus by driving student adoption, referrals, and engagement with Comet and Perplexity Pro. Gaining hands-on experience in marketing, outreach, and community building while connecting students to smarter ways to study and research.

Web Design and 3D Animator at Knight Hacks

September 2025 -

Developed admin form edit page

Created official map for KH VIII hackthon

Helping to enhance the hackathon's branding and user experience.

Helping in Dev Sprints and other tasks behind KnightHacks.

Designing the official KH website

Creating 3D animations

Director at Indian Student Association @ UCF

August 2025 - April 2026

Leading the planning and execution of Diwali and Banquet events for UCF's largest Indian student organization, coordinating with

multiple teams and clubs to deliver engaging experiences for the campus community with turnouts up-to almost 300+ attendees, improved upon previous 200 attendee count. Contributed innovative ideas and guided team members to ensure successful event execution.

Hosted the 2025 “Once Upon a Diya” diwali event and the ISA Annual Banquet events showcasing public speaking skills and event organization skills.

Supplemental Instruction Leader For COP3502 (Computer Science I) at UCF College of Engineering & Computer Science

August 2025 - December 2025

Holding collaborative study sessions for students enrolled in Computer Science I in support to Dr. Arup Guha's classes.

Facilitated both in-person and online sessions (via Zoom) to support diverse learning needs.

Designing and holding engaging review materials, practice problems, and interactive activities to reinforce course concepts.

Encouraging active participation and peer-to-peer learning to strengthen student understanding and problem-solving skills.

Supporting students in preparing for exams and assignments by breaking down complex topics into approachable steps.

Frontend Web Developer at Knight Hacks

May 2025 - September 2025

Developed forms for KH

Undergraduate AI Researcher at Interactive Computing Experiences Research Cluster

September 2024 - November 2025

Implemented QLoRA fine-tuning and weighted use of models for optimization of LLM for efficient use of resources.

Worked on improving previously made survey LLM by rebuilding the pipeline to enhance efficiency for further implementation in VR.

Assisted in improving pipeline for selective text-to-3D generation by implementing and streamlining the flow.

Conducted user studies for VR Sensor Awareness project.

Authored related works in SIGGRAPH paper submission for 3D Scene Generation from natural language.

Researcher & First Prize Winner: NSS Space Settlement Project 'Exodus' at National Space Society

December 2022 - February 2023

I independently researched and developed the NSS Space Settlement Project 'Exodus,' a pioneering initiative that won first prize in the individual category of the National Space Society's Space Settlement Contest worldwide. The project culminated in a comprehensive 50-page research document, which I presented at the International Space Development Conference (ISDC) in Arlington, Virginia, from May 27 to 29. The theme of the conference was "Living in Space."

Key Highlights of the Project and Presentation:

Innovative Research: Conducted in-depth research on sustainable living conditions in space, integrating cutting-edge technologies and innovative solutions to address the challenges of long-term space habitation.

Technical Design: Developed detailed blueprints and models, focusing on the technical feasibility, sustainability, and scalability of the proposed space settlement.

Conference Presentation: Delivered both an oral and poster presentation at the ISDC before esteemed experts in the space industry. This experience demonstrated strong communication skills and the ability to effectively convey complex ideas to a professional audience.

Strategic Vision: Created a forward-thinking proposal for future space exploration and colonization, aligning with global initiatives for sustainability and development.

This project exemplifies my dedication to advancing space exploration and demonstrates my ability to independently deliver high-quality work in a complex and challenging field.

Cultural Secretary & Event Coordinator, Student Government at Ithaka International School - India

June 2022 - April 2023

Designed and organized diverse events, including science fairs, cultural festivals, and sports fests, enhancing student engagement and community participation. Led teams of volunteers, collaborated with faculty and peers, and managed event budgets to ensure smooth execution and cost-efficiency. Developed strong leadership, organizational, and communication skills through managing multiple projects simultaneously.

Education

University of Central Florida

Bachelor, Computer Science, July 2024 - May 2028

Ithaka International School - India

2018 - 2024

Falcon Cove Middle School

August 2017 - June 2019

Music Performance, Computing (IC3 Global Standard 5 Certification) , Beginner French, Algebra 1 Honors, Film Honors
